Appendix C: Transcript of final meeting with the client

Date: 21/3/2025

Location: Mr. Weatherby's study

Client: Mr. Weatherby

Interviewer: Student Developer

Me: Good afternoon, Mr. Weatherby. Thank you for meeting with me again today. It's been a pleasure working on this project with you, and I'm excited to share the final product and hear your thoughts. To start, I'd like to reflect on the progress we've made and how the software aligns with your expectations.

Client: Good afternoon, Ryan. It's great to see you again. I'm looking forward to hearing about the final product.

Me: Thank you. Based on our previous meetings, we designed the dining hall routine software to address the key challenges you identified—fair workload distribution, avoiding scheduling conflicts, and automating the manual process currently handled by assistant house parents.

The software includes the following key features:

1. **Availability Input System:** Tutors can easily input the slots they are unavailable for, ensuring their preferences are accounted for.
2. **Automated Allocation:** The system automatically assigns tutors to available slots while adhering to the rules you specified, such as limiting each tutor to four or five slots per week.

3. **Conflict Resolution Alerts:** If a slot cannot be filled or a tutor's schedule is overbooked, the system flags it for manual adjustment.
4. **Fairness Algorithm:** It balances the workload among tutors to ensure equitable distribution.

Throughout development, I worked closely with my computer science teacher (who is one of the tutors) to test and refine the system, comparing its output to the existing manual process. The results showed increased efficiency and fewer errors.

Client: That sounds excellent. The automation and fairness features were definitely what we needed.

Me: I'm glad to hear that. I've also made the interface user-friendly with buttons, so assistant house parents can quickly adjust schedules if needed. Did you or the assistant house parents have a chance to use the software?

Client: Yes, we did. It was intuitive and made the process much quicker. The assistant house parents were especially pleased with how easy it was to input unavailability and generate a schedule.

Me: That's wonderful feedback. I'm happy to know it met your expectations. Were there any aspects of the software you felt could be improved or any features you'd like to see in future iterations?

Client: Honestly, it is very impressive. If I were to suggest anything, maybe an option to track historical schedules. It would also be good if you can make the output file, and the system interface a little bit more colorful. But overall, I think it's a great system.

Me: Thank you for that suggestion. Adding a historical tracking feature could definitely be a valuable addition. I'll note that down for potential future development.

Finally, I wanted to ask—based on your experience with the software, do you feel it has improved the process and addressed the challenges you initially shared?

Client: Absolutely. The fairness in workload distribution and the automation of assigning slots have made a significant difference. It's also freed up time for the assistant house parents to focus on other responsibilities. I'd say it's a success.

Me: That's fantastic to hear. I'm thrilled the software has made a positive impact. Thank you so much for your input throughout this project and for giving me the opportunity to work on something meaningful for the school.

Client: You've done an excellent job, Ryan. Thank you for all your hard work.

Me: Thank you, Mr. Weatherby. If there's anything else you'd like to discuss or add, please let me know. Otherwise, I'll finalize the documentation for the project and hand over the system for regular use.

Client: That sounds great. Thank you again, and good luck with the rest of your work.

Me: Thank you. I appreciate your support and feedback. Have a great day!